

If "**LDAP user and group backend**" won't activate in Nextcloud, the most common cause on Ubuntu is that the PHP LDAP extension is not installed or loaded. Nextcloud requires the PHP LDAP module (php-ldap) before the app can be enabled.

Step 1 — Check the exact error

Go to:

Profile → Apps → Integration

Open **LDAP user and group backend** and note the error.

Common error:

This app cannot be installed because the following dependencies are not fulfilled:

The library ldap is not available

This specifically means PHP LDAP is missing.

Step 2 — Check whether PHP LDAP is installed

Run:

```
php -m | grep ldap
```

Expected result

ldap

If nothing is returned, LDAP support is not loaded.

Step 3 — Install PHP LDAP

For Ubuntu 24.04 (PHP 8.3):

```
sudo apt update
```

```
sudo apt install php-ldap -y
```

The Nextcloud documentation states that the PHP LDAP module is required for LDAP/AD integration.

Step 4 — Restart Apache

```
sudo systemctl restart apache2
```

Verify:

```
php -m | grep ldap
```

Expected:

ldap

Step 5 — Verify Nextcloud sees the module

Run:

```
sudo -u www-data php -m | grep ldap
```

Expected:

ldap

This verifies the same PHP environment used by Nextcloud can load LDAP.

Step 6 — Enable the LDAP app from CLI

Sometimes the web UI fails but the CLI gives a better error:

```
sudo -u www-data php /var/www/nextcloud/occ app:enable user_ldap
```

Expected:

user_ldap enabled

If successful, LDAP commands become available in OCC.

Step 7 — Verify the app is enabled

```
sudo -u www-data php /var/www/nextcloud/occ app:list | grep user_ldap
```

Expected:

user_ldap

Step 8 — Check Nextcloud logs if it still fails

```
sudo tail -100 /var/www/nextcloud/data/nextcloud.log
```

and

```
sudo tail -100 /var/log/apache2/error.log
```

Active Directory Configuration Example

Once enabled:

Settings

└ Administration

└ LDAP / AD Integration

Typical AD settings:

Host: dc.kayson-ir.com

Port: 389

User DN:

CN=ldap-reader,CN=Users,DC=kayson-ir,DC=com

Password:

Base DN:

DC=kayson-ir,DC=com

Nextcloud can automatically detect users and groups from Active Directory once the connection tests successfully.

For your server

Please run these commands and paste the output:

```
php -v
```

```
php -m | grep ldap
```

```
sudo -u www-data php /var/www/nextcloud/occ app:enable user_ldap
```

The output of the third command will usually reveal exactly why the LDAP backend cannot be activated.